

Foundation 01 — Fitness

SECTION 01 — WHAT IS FITNESS

Fitness is the training stimulus — the physical demand that signals your body to adapt, rebuild, and perform at a higher level. It is the most visible of the Four Foundations and, for most people, the starting point.

Fitness alone is not transformation. Training without the supporting foundations of Nutrition, Sleep, and Mental/Spiritual Health produces surface-level results. Those who invest in all four Foundations look different, feel different, and build discipline that compounds for years.

Fitness is the spark. What you eat, how you sleep, and how you manage your internal state determine whether that spark becomes a sustained fire or fades out.

SECTION 02 — CORE COMPONENTS

Resistance Training

Drives muscle development, bone density, metabolic efficiency, and hormonal health. Whether bodyweight, free weights, or machines — resistance training is the primary stimulus for lean mass gains and long-term physical composition change. It also produces significant systemic benefits including improved insulin sensitivity and reduced all-cause mortality risk.

Conditioning

Builds cardiovascular capacity, improves aerobic and anaerobic efficiency, and enhances the body's ability to sustain output over time. Conditioning spans a wide range — from low-intensity steady-state sessions to maximal-effort interval training. Both ends of the spectrum serve distinct purposes and produce distinct adaptations.

Mobility

Maintains joint range of motion, reduces injury risk, and supports long-term structural integrity. Mobility work is the maintenance system that keeps every other training modality functional over time. It is not optional for high-performing individuals.

Attitude

Inside the fitness environment, attitude is the immediate determinant of whether you push, hold back, or coast. Desire and effort are the engine of the push. Where attitude goes, results follow.

There are legitimate, governed physical limits — structural, medical, or recovery-based — that define what the body can safely do on a given day. Understanding and respecting those limits is intelligence, not weakness. Within those governed boundaries, however, attitude is the variable you control completely.

SECTION 03 — MEASURING YOUR EFFORT

Training without a defined effort standard is guesswork. JPG uses two complementary tools to measure what you are actually doing — one subjective, one objective — plus five additional metrics that provide the complete performance picture.

1. Rate of Perceived Exertion (RPE)

RPE is a 1–10 scale that communicates effort intensity in subjective terms. Scale begins at 1 (entry-level warm-up) and ends at 10 (absolute maximal output). RPE accounts for daily variation — the same effort may feel different based on sleep, recovery, and stress load. It is the real-time signal your body sends.

2. Metabolic Equivalent of Task (MET)

MET is the objective measure of energy expenditure relative to rest. Sitting equals 1 MET. High-intensity intervals and sprint work range from 10 to 16+ METs. MET removes subjectivity and provides a science-backed intensity measure consistent across individuals. JPG clients typically train in the 8–12+ MET range during working sessions.

3. VO2 Max

The maximum volume of oxygen the body can utilize during intense exercise — the size of the aerobic engine. VO2 Max sets the ceiling of aerobic potential. A higher VO2 Max allows greater endurance, higher sustained work capacity, and improved cardiovascular efficiency. It is one of the strongest predictors of long-term health and all-cause mortality risk.

4. Heart Rate Variability (HRV)

HRV measures the variation in time between consecutive heartbeats. Greater variability indicates better recovery, adaptability, and autonomic nervous system balance. HRV is one of the most sensitive recovery markers

available. It is highly individual — always compare against your own baseline, not population averages. Track trends over weeks, not single-day readings.

5. Overnight HRV Status

Compares current HRV against your personal rolling baseline to produce a daily recovery status. Three categories: Balanced (proceed as planned), Elevated (hard sessions appropriate), Suppressed (modify intensity accordingly).

6. Lactate Threshold

The intensity at which lactate accumulates faster than the body can clear it — the ceiling of efficient endurance performance. Lactate Threshold is one of the strongest predictors of endurance output. Raising it through tempo and threshold training is a primary performance goal.

7. Interval Training

Alternates high-intensity work periods with recovery periods to accumulate time at intensities that cannot be held continuously. The primary tool for improving both VO2 Max and Lactate Threshold. Work intervals: RPE 8–10, MET 10–16+.

Training Types

TRAINING TYPE	PURPOSE & INTENSITY
Recovery / Active Recovery	Deliberate low-output movement. Accelerates repair without adding stress. RPE 1–3.
Zone 2 / Low Heart Rate	Sustained aerobic work at 60–70% max heart rate. Builds aerobic base and fat oxidation. RPE 3–5.
Steady State	Continuous moderate effort above Zone 2, below lactate threshold. RPE 5–6.
Tempo / Threshold	Sustained effort at or just below lactate threshold. Primary LT development tool. RPE 7–8.
Interval Training	High-intensity work/rest cycles. Primary VO2 Max and threshold driver. RPE 8–10.
Sprint / Power	Maximal short-duration efforts. Neuromuscular power and speed development. RPE 10.
Long Slow Distance (LSD)	Extended duration at Zone 2 or below. Ultra-endurance foundation. RPE 3–5.

For the complete framework — full metric explanations, measurement methods, wearable guidance, and detailed training type protocols — see JPG-FD-010-EDU: Measuring Effort and Physical Training.

SECTION 04 — HOW FITNESS CONNECTS TO THE OTHER FOUNDATIONS

Nutrition	Pre- and post-training nutrition determines whether the training stimulus produces adaptation or breakdown. Fitness creates the demand. Nutrition determines whether it is fulfilled.
Sleep	Growth hormone release during deep sleep rebuilds what training tears down. Without sleep, training creates debt, not gains.
Mental / Spiritual Health	Physical training is one of the most effective tools for building mental resilience, managing stress, and reinforcing who you are becoming. The two Foundations amplify each other.

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